Department of Information and Communication Technology
Faculty of Technology
University of Ruhuna
Management Information Systems (ICT2162)

Assignment 01 (Individual)

Imagine that your close friend has recently started a customized gift shop that sells personalized mugs, photo frames, key tags, T-shirts, greeting cards, gift boxes, and other customized gifts for occasions such as birthdays, anniversaries, weddings, graduations, and corporate events.

Although the shop offers a variety of personalized products, your friend is struggling to attract enough customers. Most customers in the area now search for gift ideas through social media platforms and online stores before making a purchase. Many competitors are also promoting their customized products through Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, and other online platforms. In addition, a significant portion of the business revenue is spent on shop rent and other operational expenses. Customers usually have to visit the physical shop to view available products, discuss customization requirements, and place orders. As a result, the business is finding it difficult to compete with online sellers who provide convenient ordering and home-delivery services. Your friend is now considering closing the physical shop and operating the business primarily through online channels.

However, since you are an **ICT undergraduate studying Management Information Systems**, you realize that information technology can be used strategically to transform the business model and gain a competitive advantage. Instead of closing the business, you plan to advise your friend to move towards an online-based business model by using an e-commerce website and social media platforms to display products, allow customers to customize gifts, place orders, and make payments.

You are required to write a report explaining how you would advise your friend by emphasizing how IT can be used to gain competitive advantage in this scenario using Porter's Five Forces Model as the framework for your analysis.

Assume that,

- The business offers **unique and customizable gift products at affordable prices**.
- The business can obtain the necessary raw materials and gift items from alternative suppliers without significant delay.
- If the business moves online, **all customer orders can be delivered through a reliable courier service**, ensuring smooth delivery operations.
- Customers can make payments using **digital payment methods** when placing online orders.
- The government is actively promoting **online and digital business operations for entrepreneurs**.

Report Submission Requirements

Upload your report as a **word document** on or before 11.00 p.m. 16th Friday, October 2026, to the given link in LMS.

1. Your report should contain no more than 8 pages. (including the cover page and reference)
2. This assessment is an **individual assessment**.
3. Include below given details on cover page.
    a. Course Title and course code (Centered, Times New Roman, Bold, 20)
    b. Assessment no (Right Aligned, Times New Roman, 14)
    c. Your name (Right Aligned, Times New Roman, 14)
    d. Your registration no (Right Aligned, Times New Roman, 14)
    e. Default Margins
    f. No Borders.
4. Must include a content page
5. Content
    a. font (Times New Roman, 12)
    b. page numbers – bottom of the page
    c. Content should be Justify
6. References
7. **All of your reports will be checked for plagiarism**
    a. If found all the parties involved will get 0 marks for the assessment
8. No late submissions are allowed

********** End **********